

businesses, and of course all of those pundits either own or invest in a company that promises to get your business ready for the social commerce onslaught they foresee. So is it just a scam to extract money from small businesses, or is there some truth to this? Honestly, influencers are already indulging in affiliate marketing, and giving everything glowing reviews so that people buy them. It's just going to get a lot easier for people to get affiliate IDs, and start recommending products, linking to them, and starting to earn money. Facebook will probably roll out such a scheme and offer to pay you for products sold by people clicking on your link. We half expect Facebook to release a statement at some point in the next decade, saying that while Zuckerberg promised "Facebook is free, and will always be", he's taking those words back. While you will never have to pay Facebook, it will now start paying you, and thus isn't "free" because it's earning you money! As corny as that sounds, it would be a huge change for a social media service to start selling stuff and essentially trying to become an Amazon.

What's far more likely is that users themselves will do this with or without a social media service's help, and what we see happening on YouTube will just happen everywhere else also now. Fashion is the pioneer in this space, so watch them to see where we're headed...

Social media is already being used to get bulk deals by buying large quantities collectively, and this trend will probably continue to grow. It will also be used to popularise very small businesses, and companies will watch social media like hawks to get new ideas or just buy the rights to new ideas away from some very creative people.

While there may be more pitfalls that social media services will need to avoid we are running out of space to cover any more. Especially important to such services are any rules and laws being enacted by the governments of the world, as these will be the biggest headaches for social media services in the future. 📌

TIK TOK TWO

What kind of services will Gen C be using?

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Our apologies for the headline. It's a play on words of Tic Tac Toe, and was our effort to be cerebral, but we just end up revealing our age. If some kid from Generation C is reading this in the future, he or she is definitely going to have to Google what TikTok, Tic Tacs, and Tic Tac Toe are. Will Google still be the default place to look up stuff then? Let's not get distracted from our rabbit hole by veering left into another just yet...

The aim of this article was to try and walk through all we know about social media trends, the psychology of people, the various forms of greed that drive the world, the rebellious nature of kids, and much more, all to be able to answer a simple question. What will the social media of the future look like when Gen C kids use it.

The answer? Who knows! But we can guess based on the trends we have spotted, and we're sure by now, so can you.

LOCAL AND LINGUAL

This one is kind of obvious. Not only do we see social media moving away from the behemoths that house almost all of the planet's online population, we see them being broken down into far more than merely the country level. While there will be a charm to being on a social network that has people from across the globe, just look at how we use WhatsApp in groups to get an idea of where we're headed. In fact, depending on how old you are and which



This is something that we might not be able to get rid of.